

# *The Ad That* CHANGED *Advertising*

## The Story Behind Volkswagen's *'Think Small'* Campaign

The Volkswagen was beginning to sell extensively throughout Europe during the 1950s as laws regulating exports from Germany were relaxed. The car was becoming popular. Through word of mouth advertising, the Volkswagen was even selling in America to those who weren't convinced by the stylish and expensive offerings from Chevrolet and Oldsmobile.

With sales of 100,000 Volkswagens in 1958, the major manufacturers could no longer ignore the market for small cars and were gearing up to release their own. To tackle this incoming threat Volkswagen sent a man named Carl Hahn to America. His job was to do something that Volkswagen hadn't done before— ***advertise.***